

Week 6 — Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

"Every artifact you've produced — PRD, TCD, TMD — is a starting position. This week you negotiate it into a shipping position."

Week 6 takes the documents from Weeks 3–5 and uses them as **inputs to real conversations**. The TCD Section 6 stakeholder sign-off matrix becomes the negotiation list. The TMD's trade-offs become the things you have to explain. The PRD's scope becomes the thing you have to defend.

By Friday afternoon, every triad has run **three simulated negotiations** with cohort members playing stakeholders, has logged outcomes, and ships a **Stakeholder Engagement Plan (SEP)** — the fourth and final sibling artifact alongside PRD / TCD / TMD.

What's different about Week 6

- **It's outward-facing.** Earlier weeks were authoring weeks; this week is conversation.
- **Friday is simulation-heavy** — small-group breakouts, role plays, multi-round negotiations.
- **AI returns as meeting-prep tool** (Day 4) — not as a replacement for human judgment.
- **Every artifact across Weeks 3–5 is in scope** — stakeholders may push on data, architecture, SLOs, scope, or anything else.

Learning outcomes

By Friday afternoon, each participant can:

1. **Map** the stakeholders for a feature using a Power × Interest grid + a RACI assignment, distinguishing decision-makers from approvers from informees.
2. **Plan engagement** per stakeholder — frequency, format, what they need from us, what we need from them.
3. **Translate** a technical trade-off (from TCD or TMD) into a 1-page brief a non-technical executive can act on.

4. **Use AI** to prepare for a stakeholder meeting: summarize prior context, predict objections, draft an opening — with explicit validation.
5. **Negotiate** scope / time / quality / resources in a structured exchange and capture the outcome in a way the team can act on.

Daily map

Day	Topic	Key artifact produced
1	Identifying & mapping stakeholders	SEP Section 1 — Stakeholder map (Power x Interest, RACI)
2	Managing engagement for outcomes	SEP Section 2 — Engagement plan
3	Communicating technical trade-offs	SEP Section 3 — One-page trade-off brief
4	AI-augmented requirement summaries	SEP Section 4 — Meeting prep + objection map
5	Negotiating priorities & roadmaps	SEP Section 5 — Negotiation outcomes log (3 simulated rounds)

The SEP ships Friday alongside the PRD, TCD, and TMD.

Daily cadence

Clock	Block	Mix
09:00 – 09:15	Opening & objectives	Instructor
09:15 – 10:30	Teaching Block 1 + Activity 1	~25 min teach / 50 min triad work
10:30 – 10:45	Break	
10:45 – 12:00	Teaching Block 2 + Activity 2	~25 min teach / 50 min triad work
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch	
13:00 – 14:15	Teaching Block 3 + Activity 3	~25 min teach / 50 min triad work
14:15 – 14:30	Break	
14:30 – 16:00	Teaching Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	~25 min teach / 45 min triad / 20 min wrap

Friday cadence (negotiation simulation)

Friday's blocks are simulation-heavy:

Clock	Block	What happens
09:00 – 09:15	Opening; sim pairings posted	Triads + their counterpart triads (playing stakeholders) named
09:15 – 10:45	Round 1: Architecture / SLO negotiation	Triad negotiates one TCD Section 4 SLO or Section 5 trade-off
10:45 – 11:00	Break	
11:00 – 12:00	Round 1 debrief + Round 2 prep	Role-swap; capture outcomes
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch	
13:00 – 14:30	Round 2: Scope negotiation	Triad negotiates a non-goal challenge or scope-creep ask
14:30 – 14:45	Break	
14:45 – 15:45	Round 3: Resource / timeline negotiation	Cross-team dependency or roadmap ask
15:45 – 16:00	Wrap + sign-off	SEP Section 5 outcomes log finalized

The SEP template

```
# Stakeholder Engagement Plan – <feature>
**Sibling to:** PRD <link>, TCD <link>, TMD <link>
**Authors:** <triad> | **Status:** Draft / Reviewed

## 1. Stakeholder map
Power × Interest grid + RACI for the feature. Pulls from TCD Section 6
sign-off matrix.

## 2. Engagement plan
Per stakeholder: cadence, format, what they need from us,
what we need from them.

## 3. Trade-off translation brief
One TCD/TMD trade-off, translated to one page for a non-technical
executive. Includes: business framing, options, recommendation,
the call you need from them.

## 4. Meeting-prep + objection map
Prior context (AI-summarized + validated), predicted top objections,
opening you'd lead with, the non-negotiables.

## 5. Negotiation outcomes log
For each simulated round: the ask, the response, the agreement
(or disagreement), the next step.
```

Triads

Same triads from Weeks 1–5. Friday's simulations pair triads as **author + stakeholder** — triads play each other's stakeholders, swapping roles round to round.

Friday simulation rubric

For each negotiation round, both sides score on:

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Listened first	20%	Restated stakeholder's concern accurately before responding
Translated tech to business	20%	No unexplained jargon; framed cost in business terms
Held the line where it mattered	15%	Did not surrender constraints under social pressure without rationale
Found the trade space	20%	Surfaced what could move (scope, time, quality, resources)
Captured the outcome	15%	Specific, written, with owner + next step
Body / pacing / closure	10%	Conversation reached a decision (or explicit deferral)

Bridge to Week 7

Week 7 (Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery) takes the negotiated commitments into delivery. The SEP Section 5 outcomes log becomes the **input to sprint planning**. Constraints that survived negotiation become the work; deferred items become the backlog; rejected asks get a documented "no" with reasoning.